

SWEEP rule on the KD-Toric code

March 11, 2026

1 SWEEP Rule Decoder on the Toric

The decoder works as follows: each vertex v looks for a suggestion $\hat{v}$ on $\uparrow(v) \cap lk_2$ that matches σ_v^+ . If there are more than one, then pick the one which has the minimal weight.

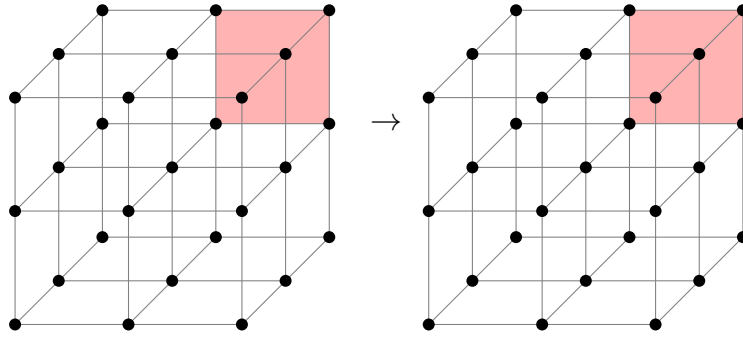


Figure 1: SWEEP rule

2 Span Shrinking

Define the potentials functions $L_i : \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ as follow¹:

$$L_i(\mathbf{x}) = \begin{cases} \mathbf{x}_i & i < d + 1 \\ -\langle \mathbf{1}, \mathbf{x} \rangle & i = d + 1 \end{cases}$$

The **Size** of a subset S is defined as:

$$\mathbf{Size}(S) = \sum_i \max_{\mathbf{x} \in S} L_i(\mathbf{x})$$

¹Notice that we use opposite signs relative to Berman and Peter Gacs, yet we agree with Perskil.

Claim 2.1 (Span Shrinking Property). Namely, let e be an unsatisfied check at time t , and let H_e be the unsatisfied checks at time $t - 1$. Then there is a set $H'_e \subset H_e$ such that:

1. For any $i < d + 1$ there exists $e' \in H'_e$ such $L_i(e') \geq L_i(e)$.
2. There exists $e' \in H'_e$ such that $L_{d+1}(e') \leq L_{d+1}(e) + 1$.

Remark 2.1. Numerically, we showed that the 'span shrinking property' holds for the checks on the 3D Toric (it required running over $\sim 2^{11}$ assignments of bits over the local environment of the check).

Proof. Consider a vertex v which at time t adjoins to an unsatisfied edge e , let u, w be vertices which have a positive faces that adjoin to e .

1. If $\hat{u}|_e \neq \emptyset$, then the parallel edge to e going out from u belongs to H_e . Denote it by e_u , taking e_u satisfies at least two (three in 4D) of the first d inequalities and the last $d + 1$ th inequality. Denote by $x \in [d]$ the index of the inequality which isn't satisfied by e_u . So it remains to prove the existence of $e' \in H_e$ for which $L_x(e') \geq L_x(e)$.

Consider the assignment of bits at time $t - 1$ over the complex, and consider the graph $G = (\mathcal{F}, E)$ induced by associating vertices with any face that is set to 1 by the assignment. Two vertices are connected if their origin faces share an edge. Let $K \subset \mathcal{F}$ be a connected component of faces that contains the faces supported on u .

We say that K is d far from u if:

$$\max_{f \in K} |f_x - u_x| \leq d$$

Now, we will prove by induction on d that there is a face $f \in K$ with $f_x \geq v_x$ such one of its edge is not satisfied.

- (a) **Base.** The edge from v which point at the $\hat{z}$ direction must not be satisfied.
- (b) **Assumption.** Assume that for any K which is at most $d - 1$ far from u there is a face, with adjoins edge that is both has a x -coordinate that is greater than u_x and is not satisfied.
- (c) **Induction Step.** Consider a connected component K that is d -far from u . Notice that if by substitute a co-boundary (stabilizer) from K we get K' that is at most d' far from u for some $d' < d$ then we done. That because: $\partial_2 K' = \partial_2(K + z) = \partial_2 K$ for some $z \in \ker \partial_2$.

On the other hand, [\[COMMENT\]](#) Finish that.

2. Else, if for any $u \in \downarrow(u) \cap lk_1$ it holds that $\hat{u}|_e = \emptyset$, then it must be that $e \in H_e$ because $\hat{v}$ can only decrease the syndrome on v . Moreover, it follows that $\hat{v} = \emptyset$ (otherwise, the suggestion would zero out the syndrome on $\uparrow(v) \cap lk_2$). Thus, $\sigma_v \not\subset \uparrow(v) \cap lk_2 \Rightarrow$ there is also an edge $e' \in H_e$ where $e' \in \downarrow(v)$. In that case, take $e \in H_e$ as the edge satisfies the first d equalities and e' for satisfying the $d + 1$ th inequality.

□

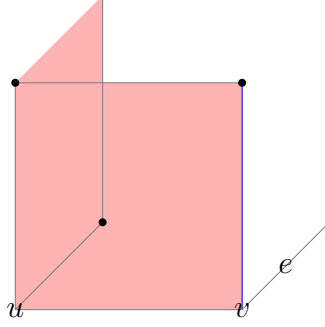


Figure 2: The induction base: In red, we have the faces on the support of u . The blue edge has the same x -coordinate as e . Any attempt to zero out the syndrome on the edge results in adding a face that is at least 2-far from u . Any configuration which is at most 1-far from u has to have that local view, yet might be connected to more faces which don't adjoin the blue edge.

3 SWEEP Rule Decoder on the Toric, version II.

Consider the presentation of a d -dimensional toric by the Cayley graph of the $(\mathbb{Z}_n^d, +)$ group generated by the elements $S = \{1_i : i \in [d]\}$ (where 1_i is the vector consisting of one at the i th coordinate and zero elsewhere). We say that an edge $\{x, y\}$ is positive relative to a plaquette $\{v, g_1v, g_2g_1v, g_2v\}$, defined by a rooted vertex $v \in \mathbb{Z}_n^d$ and the generators $g_1, g_2 \in S$, if $x = v$ and y is either g_1v or g_2v . In our code, bits are set on the plaquette, and the edges correspond to checks that restrict the parity of the bits on their support to be even.

We generalize Toom's rule in the following manner: Each plaquette asks if both of its positive edges point to a syndrome, namely unsatisfied. If so, then the bit flips itself; for convenience, we will think of the vertex at the end of the positive edges as the vertex which makes the decision and flips the plaquette.

Let $\sigma^{(t)}$ be a domain wall at time t , and let $\Gamma^t = \{v : \exists \{v, u\} \in \sigma^t\}$. We denote by ϕ^t the subsets of bits which are flipped as a result of applying the Toom's rule at time t , and by ϕ_v the bits which are flipped by vertex v . We say that u is added to Γ^{t+1} by v at time t , if $u \in \Gamma^{t+1}$ and $u \in V(\phi_v)$. When it clear from the context, we will omit the time, and say that u is added by v .

Claim 3.1. Let $v \in \Gamma^t$ for any u that is added by v , and for any $x \in [d+1]$, we have $L_x(u) \leq L_x(v) + 1$.

Proof. By definition, any u that is added by v is of the form $v + \sum \alpha_j 1_j$, where $\alpha_j \in \{0, 1\}$ and $\sum \alpha_j \leq 2$. Thus, for any $x \in [d]$:

$$L_x(u) = \langle 1_x, v + \sum \alpha_j 1_j \rangle = \langle 1_x, v \rangle + \alpha_x \leq L_x(v) + 1$$

For $x = d+1$ we have:

$$L_x(u) = \langle -\mathbf{1}, v + \sum \alpha_j 1_j \rangle = \langle -\mathbf{1}, v \rangle - \sum_j \alpha_j \leq L_x(v)$$

□

Claim 3.2. Let $v \in \Gamma^t$ such that $L_{d+1}(v)$ is a (local) maxima in Γ^t then for any u which is added by v we have $L_{d+1}(u) \leq L_{d+1}(v) - 1$.

Proof. We will prove that $v \notin \Gamma^{t+1}$, and then by repeating on claim 3.1 where $\sum \alpha_j \geq 1$, we get the desired result. Assume, toward contradiction, that $v \in \Gamma^{t+1}$, and denote by w the vertex that adds v . If $w \neq v$, then there is at least one coordinate i for which $w_i < v_i$, thus $L_{d+1}(w) > L_{d+1}(v)$, in contradiction to $L_{d+1}(v)$ being a maximum in Γ^t . In the other case, where v adds itself, it follows that σ_v can't be decomposed into pairs of unsatisfied checks; namely, $|\sigma_v|$ is odd. We show by induction that impossible, namely that $|\sigma_v|$ is always even. The induction is over the size of the plaquettes subset that induce the boundary σ .

1. Base. Consider a boundary that induced by a single plaquette, in that case it obvious that $|\sigma_v|$ is either zero (where v is not belong to the plaquette) or 2.
2. Assume for any boundary that induced by at most k plaquettes, and consider a boundary σ which is induced by $k + 1$ plaquettes, name this subset F and observes that F can be decomposed to a sum of two disjoint subsets A and B , each with less than $k + 1$ plaquettes, Now:

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma_v &= (\partial A)_v \cup (\partial B)_v \\ \Rightarrow |\sigma_v| &= |(\partial A)_v| + |(\partial B)_v| - 2|(\partial A)_v \cap (\partial B)_v| = \text{even}\end{aligned}$$

Where we used the induction assumption, which tells that $|(\partial A)_v|$ and $|(\partial B)_v|$ are even numbers.

□

Claim 3.3. Let $x \in [d]$ and let $v \in \Gamma^t$ such that $L_x(v)$ is a (local) maxima in Γ^t then for any u which is added by v we have $L_x(u) \leq L_x(v)$.

Proof. Since $L_x(v)$ is maximal, v doesn't see edges that goes from it at the positive x -direction, otherwise denote it by e and denote by w the second vertex at the end of e , w has an x -coordinate which is greater than v 's x -coordinate by 1 and in addition $w \in \Gamma^t$ (since it lays on the support of e). Therefore $L_x(w) > L_x(v)$ in contradiction to $L_x(v)$ be maximal in Γ^t . Hence, any plaquette that is being flipped by v lies on edges associated with 1_j such that $j \neq x$. Thus, any vertex u that is added by v has the form $v + \sum_{j \in [d] \setminus \{x\}} \alpha_j 1_j$, where $\alpha_j \in \{0, 1\}$ and $\sum \alpha_j \leq 2$. So:

$$L_x(u) = \langle 1_x, v + \sum_{j \in [d] \setminus \{x\}} \alpha_j 1_j \rangle = \langle 1_x, v \rangle = L_x(v)$$

□

Claim 3.4. Let Γ^t be the vertices in the support of the domain wall σ^t . Denote $v_i = \arg \max_{v \in \Gamma^t} L_i(v)$. Then for any $i \in [d]$, one can find $u \in \Gamma^{t-1}$ such that u adds v_i and $L_i(u) \geq L_i(v_i)$. In addition, one can find $u_{d+1} \in \Gamma^{t-1}$ such that u_{d+1} adds v_{d+1} and $L_{d+1}(u_{d+1}) = L_{d+1}(v_{d+1}) + 1$.

Proof. Just take u_i to be any vertex that adds v_i . By claims claim 3.1, claim 3.2, and claim 3.3, we get the claim. □

[COMMENT] $V(\phi_v)$ was not defined. $v \leq w$ also not defined.

4 SWEEP Rule Decoder on the Toric, version III

Consider the presentation of a d -dimensional torus by the Cayley graph $G = (V, E)$ of the $(\mathbb{Z}_n^d, +)$ group generated by the elements $S = \{1_i : i \in [d]\}$ (where 1_i is the vector consisting of one at the i th coordinate and zero elsewhere). We say that an edge $\{x, y\}$ is positive relative to a plaquette $\{v, g_1v, g_2g_1v, g_2v\}$, defined by a rooted vertex $v \in \mathbb{Z}_n^d$ and the generators $g_1, g_2 \in S$, if $x = v$ and y is either g_1v or g_2v .

In our code, bits are set on the plaquette, and the edges correspond to checks that restrict the parity of the bits on their support to be even. Denote the set of plaquettes by $\mathcal{F}$, and let us abuse the notation by using it to refer also to the bits.

We generalize Toom's rule in the following manner: Each plaquette asks if both of its positive edges point to a syndrome, namely, are unsatisfied. If so, then the bit flips itself; for convenience, we will think of the vertex at the end of the positive edges (in the 2D bottom-left corner) as the vertex that makes the decision and flips, or does not flip, the plaquette. For a vertex $v \in V$ and plaquette $f \in \mathcal{F}$, we say that $v \in f$ if and only if v is one of the four vertices on f 's corners.

Definition 4.1 (v adds u at time t). Let $D^{(t)} \subset \mathcal{F}$ be the bits that deviate from the ideal running at time t [\[COMMENT\] Define it!](#). Let $\Gamma^{(t)} \subset V$ be the vertices that support the plaquettes in $D^{(t)}$. Namely, $\Gamma^{(t)} = \{v : \exists f \in D^{(t)} \text{ s.t. } v \in f\}$. In other words, $\Gamma^{(t)}$ are the vertices that, at time t , are adjacent to a deviated bit. Similarly, denote by $\Gamma^{*(t)}$ the vertices that at time t adjacent to deviate bits which are not belongs to the faults, i.e $\Gamma^{*(t)} = \{v : \exists f \in D^{(t)}/\mathcal{E}^{(t)} \text{ s.t. } v \in f\}$. We say that for vertices $v, u \in V$, v adds u at time t , if the following conditions hold:

1. $v \in \Gamma^{t-1}$ and $u \in \Gamma^{*(t)}$
2. There exists $f \in \mathcal{F}$ such that $v, u \in f$.
3. $v \leq u$, namely $v_i \leq u_i$ for any $i \in [d]$.

For a time t , we define the function $P_t : V \rightarrow 2^V$ that, for a vertex u , returns the set of vertices that add u .

Claim 4.1 (Shrinking Lemma). For any $u \in \Gamma^{*(t)}$, there are $v_1, \dots, v_{d+1} \in P_t(u)$, not necessarily different, such that for any $i \leq d$, it holds that $L_i(v_i) = L_i(u)$, and for $i = d + 1$, it holds that $L_{d+1}(v_{d+1}) \geq L_{d+1}(u) + 1$.

To prove it, we will need the following claim:

Claim 4.2. For any $u \in \Gamma^{*(t)}$, there is at least one $v \in P_t(u)$ such that $v < u$.

Proof. Since $u \in \Gamma^{*(t)}$ there must be $f \in D^{(t)}/\mathcal{E}^{(t)}$ such $u \in f$.

- If $f \in D^{(t-1)}$, then it least one of its positive edge

□

Proof. Consider $u \in \Gamma^{*(t)}$. By claim 4.2 there is at least one $v \in P_t(u)$ satisfies $v < u$, choose it to be v_{d+1} . Recall that since the vertices are the points of the d -dimensional lattice embedded in $\mathbb{R}^d$, the inequality $v < u$ implies that there exists at least single $i \in [d]$ such $v + \mathbf{1}_i \leq u$. Therefore we get:

$$L_{d+1}(v_{d+1}) = -\langle \mathbf{1}, v_{d+1} \rangle = -\sum_{j \in [d]} v_j = -\sum_{j \in [d]/i} v_j - v_i \geq -\langle \mathbf{1}, u \rangle + 1 = L_{d+1}(u) + 1$$

Now let's split to cases upon whether $u \in \Gamma^{(t-1)}$.

- If $u \in \Gamma^{(t-1)}$ then picking it for the vertices $v_1, \dots, v_d$ finishes the proof.
- Else, there has to be a plaquette $f \in D^{(t)}/D^{(t-1)}$ such that $v \in f$. Thus, f was flipped at time t . Since, by the definition of Toom's rule, a plaquette is flipped only if two of its edges are unsatisfied², we get that at least three vertices of f are adjacent to unsatisfied checks at time $t-1$, namely adjacent to plaquettes in $D^{(t-1)}$ ³.

Since those vertices are the vertices of $f/\{u\}$, two of them, let's say a and b , differ from u at only one coordinate, let's say j_a and j_b , respectively. Therefore, define:

$$v_i = \begin{cases} v_a & a \neq j_a \\ v_b & \text{else} \end{cases}$$

Clearly, we got the equalities for $i \leq d$. □

²Here the argument works no matter which edges have been flipped.

³Those plaquettes are adjacent to f .

5 Investigation

[COMMENT] To do: understands how the investigation should look like. Plot an example to such tree. The model goes as follow, at each even iteration we toss a noise, then in each odd iteration we perform a single SWEEP rule iteration. That allows to track over the history of the errors.

We say that a check $e \in \text{Error}$, if there is a face f that adjoin to e and belongs to the Error.

Definition 5.1 (Investigation). For any unsatisfied check e at time t , we define V (the set of checks which participated in 'misleading' of e), and two sets of edges on V , Arrows and Forks via the following algorithm:

```

1 let  $V = \{e\}$ , Arrows =  $\emptyset$ , Forks =  $\emptyset$ 
2 let  $Q \leftarrow \text{queue } \{e\}$ 
3 while  $Q$  is not empty do
4    $e' \leftarrow \text{dequeue } Q$ 
5   if  $e' \notin \text{Error}$  then
6      $e_1, \dots, e_l \leftarrow \text{Excuse}(e')$ 
7     Insert  $\{e_i, e'\}$  to Arrows
8     Insert  $\{e_i, e_j\}$  to Forks
9   end
10 end

```

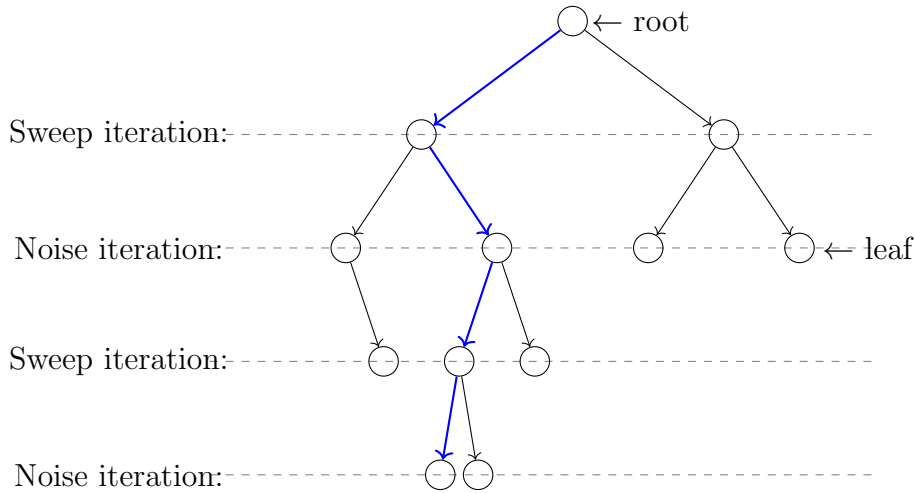


Figure 3: blabla

6 Space-Time Graph

Definition 6.1. Consider a graph $G = (V, A, F)$, where V is a set of vertices, and A, F are sets of undirected edges. For $v \in V$, denote by $\text{pre}(v) = \{u \in V : \{u, v\} \in A\}$, we extend the notion for subsets of vertices $X \subset V$ by $\text{pre}(X) = \bigcup_{v \in X} \text{pre}(v)$. Let $T : V \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$, We say that (G, T) is a time graph iff:

1. $\{x, y\} \in A \Rightarrow T(y) = T(x) \pm 1$
2. For $x, y \in V$ $\{x, y\} \in F$ iff there exists $z \in V$ such both $\{x, z\}, \{y, z\} \in A$.

We will call to T time-function, to A arrows, and to F forks. Observe that from the second requirement it follows that forks can connect only vertices that have the same time value (set by T).

Definition 6.2 (History, slice.). For a time graph (G, T) and a vertex $u \in V$, let G_u be the subgraph of (V, A) induced by $\{v \in V : T(v) \leq T(u)\}$. We will denote by H_u the 'History of u ', which is the set of vertices that are connected to u in G_u . A slice is an equivalence class of the relation $u \equiv v$ iff $H_u = H_v$. Notice that the time function has to be constant on a slice, to see this consider vertices x, y with $T(x) > T(y)$, thus $x \notin G_y$ and therefore $x \in H_x/H_y$. So they are belong to different classes. Thus, we can extend the time function and the history to slices and write for a slice K : $T(K)$ and H_K .

Claim 6.1. Consider slices K_1, K_2 such that $T(K_1) = T(K_2)$, then either $K_1 = K_2$ or H_{K_1}, H_{K_2} are disjoint.

Proof. Assume a non-empty intersection, so there exists $z \in H_{K_1} \cap H_{K_2}$ such that for any $x \in K_1$ and $y \in K_2$, there exist arrow-paths $z \rightarrow x$ and $z \rightarrow y$. Thus, for any $w \in H_{K_1}$, one can concatenate a path $w \rightarrow x \rightarrow z \rightarrow y$ and conclude that $y \in H_{K_2}$. $\square$

Definition 6.3 (The graph of slice). Let K be a slice. The graph of K , denoted by $G_K = (V_K, E_K)$, is the graph whose vertices are slices $R \subset H_K$ with $T(R) = T(K) - 1$. Two vertices are connected by an edge if and only if there is a fork whose ends belong to the slices associated with them. Namely, $S, R \in V_K$ are connected in G_K if and only if there is $\{s, r\} = f \in F$ such that $s \in S$ and $r \in R$.

Claim 6.2. G_K is connected.

Proof. Let $R, S \in V_K$ and consider $r, s \in V$ such that $r \in R, s \in S$. Recall that $R, S \subset H_K$ and therefore $r, s \in H_K$. Thus, by definition of the 'History' there exists a path, passing through arrows only, from r to s in H_K . Consider such a path that is minimal in the number of points x belong to it, with $T(x) = T(K)$. By induction on the number k of such points we prove that R and S are connected in G_K .

1. Base. $k = 0$, In this case, the path from r to s lies within $G_r (= G_s)$. Hence $H_r = H_s$, So $R = S$.

2. Induction step. There exists y on the path from r to s such that $T(y) = T(K)$. Let x be the point which precedes y on the path, and z the point that follows y . Since the values of T at the two ends of an arrow differ by 1, and since y gets the maximal T value in H_K it follows that:

- (a) $\{x, z\} \subset \text{pre}(y) \Rightarrow \{x, z\} \in F$.
- (b) The slices of x and z , say K_x and K_z has time value $T(K_x) = T(K_z) = T(K) - 1$, Namely they are both members of V_K .

Since the path connecting r, x in H_K has $k - 1$ vertices with $T(\cdot) = T(K)$, then by the induction hypothesis, R and K_x are connected in G_K , and by similar argument so are K_z and S . On the other hand, $\{x, z\} \Rightarrow \{K_x, K_z\} \in E_K$. Thus, R and S are connected in G_K .

□

Definition 6.4. Let $f : G \hookrightarrow \mathbb{R}^d$ be an embedding that maps each element of $V \cup A \cup F$ to a point in $\mathbb{R}^d$. We say that $(G, \mathbb{R}^d)$ is a space-time graph iff:

- 1.
2. The point set by f for an edge is the mean of its endpoints' images; that is, for $e = \{x, y\} \in A \cup F$, we have $f(e) = \frac{1}{2}(f(x) + f(y))$.

Definition 6.5. Define $\text{pre}_i(v) = \arg \max_{u \in \text{pre}(v)} L_i(f(u))$

Claim 6.3. Let $\mathbf{S} = \{S_1, S_2, \dots, S_k\}$ where $S_i \subset \mathbb{R}^d$, introduce an edge between S_i and S_j iff $S_i \cap S_j \neq \emptyset$. Assume that $\mathbf{S}$ is connected. Then $\mathbf{Size}(\cup_{i=1}^k S_i) \leq \sum_{i=1}^k \mathbf{Size}(S_i)$.

Proof. It suffices to prove that if $R_1 \cap R_2 \neq \emptyset$, then $\mathbf{Size}(R_1 \cup R_2) \leq \mathbf{Size}(R_1) + \mathbf{Size}(R_2)$. Let $a_{i,j} = \max_{v \in R_j} L_i(v)$. Then for any $w \in R_1 \cap R_2$ we have:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{Size}(R_1 \cup R_2) &= \sum_i^{d+1} \max a_{i,1}, a_{i,2} = \sum_i^{d+1} a_{i,1} + a_{i,2} - \min a_{i,1}, a_{i,2} \\ &\leq \sum_i^{d+1} a_{i,1} + a_{i,2} - L_i(w) = \mathbf{Size}(R_1) + \mathbf{Size}(R_2) - \mathbf{Size}(w) \\ &= \mathbf{Size}(R_1) + \mathbf{Size}(R_2) \end{aligned}$$

□

Definition 6.6 (Spanned Set). Consider an embedding $f : \star \hookrightarrow \mathbb{R}^d$, a subset of f 's domain $S \subset \star$, and $d + 1$ points $x_1, \dots, x_{d+1}$. We say that $\langle S, x_1, \dots, x_{d+1} \rangle$ is a spanned set of S if for any $i \in [d + 1]$ and $s \in S$, it holds that $L(f(s)) \leq L_i(x_i)$ and in addition there are $v_1, \dots, v_{d+1} \in V$, not necessary different, that achieve the equalities $L_i(x_i) = L_i(f(v_i))$. We name $x_1, \dots, x_{d+1}$ the poles of S . Furthermore, we extend the notation to a spanned slice when S is a slice of some time-graph. Notice that saying $\langle S, x_1, \dots, x_{d+1} \rangle$ is a spanned set means that $\mathbf{Size}(S) = \mathbf{Size}(\{x_1, \dots, x_{d+1}\})$.

Observe that in the case where the subset S is a slice. Each of these poles can be associated with a vertex of G that gives the equality. If there are multiple vertices whose images by f give equality, associate the point with one of them arbitrarily. We will use the notion of applying functions originally defined over vertices to the poles, referring to the application over the vertices associated with them. For example $\text{pre}(x_i) = \text{pre}(v)$ for the vertex $v \in S$ which satisfies $L_i(f(v)) = L_i(x_i)$ and therefore is associated with the pole x_i . Another example is referring to x_i as a vertex, so when saying 'For $x_i \in V_k$ ' or 'For $\{x_i, u\} \in F$ ', we refer to the associated vertex or the edge connecting it to u .

Claim 6.4. Consider a time graph (G, T) , an embedding $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^d$, such that.. , Let K be a slice in G , and let $\hat{K} = \langle K, x_1, \dots, x_{d+1} \rangle$ be a spanned slice of K such that $K \neq H_K$. Then for some integer k there exist spanned slices $\hat{K}_0 = \langle K_0, \cdot \rangle, \dots, \hat{K}_k = \langle K_k, \cdot \rangle$ and Forks $F_1, \dots, F_k$ such that:

1. For $i \in [d+1]$ $\text{pre}_i(x_i)$ belongs to the poles $\hat{K}_0, \dots, \hat{K}_k$.
2. Introduce an edge between $\hat{K}_i$ and $\hat{K}_j$ if and only if one of the Forks $F_1, \dots, F_k$ consists of a pole of $\hat{K}_i$ and a pole of $\hat{K}_j$. Then the graph formed from $\hat{K}_0, \dots, \hat{K}_k$ is connected.
3. $\sum_{i=0}^k \text{Size}(\hat{K}_i) + \sum_{i=1}^k \text{Size}(F_i) \geq \text{Size}(\hat{K}) + 1$

Proof. First Notice that K doesn't contain leaves in (V, A) , since a leaf is connected only to itself via arrows, and therefore its 'slice' equals to its 'History'. Thus $\text{pre}_i(x_i)$ is not empty for $i = 1, \dots, d+1$. Next consider the graph $G_K = (V_K, E_K)$ from definition 6.3. Since $\{x_i, \text{pre}_i(x_i)\}$ is an arrow $\text{pre}_i(x_i)$ belongs to a slice in V_K . for $i = 1, \dots, d+1$ denote by R_i the slice in V_K that contains $\text{pre}_i(x_i)$.

By claim 6.2 G_K is connected and therefore there exist a minimal collection $\{K_0, \dots, K_k\}$ of slices from V_K which contains $R_1, R_2, \dots, R_{d+1}$, and which is connected in G_K . We pick a set of forks $\mathbf{F} = \{F_1, \dots, F_k\}$ which realizes a spanning tree for this collection of slices. Later we will identify edges from this spanning tree with the forks from $\mathbf{F}$.

For $i = 1, \dots, d+1$ we set $\text{pre}_i(v_i)$ to be the i th pole of R_i , This assures (1). The set of remaining poles for $\hat{K}_0, \dots, \hat{K}_k$ will be equal to $\cup_{i=k}^k F_i$. This will assure (ii), We will also select poles for $F_1, \dots, F_k$ to form 'spanned forks' $\hat{F}_1, \dots, \hat{F}_k$ in such way that:

$$\sum_{i=0}^k \text{Size}(\hat{K}_i) + \sum_{i=1}^k \text{Size}(\hat{F}_i) \geq \sum_{i=1}^{d+1} L_i(\text{pre}_i(v_i)) \geq \text{Size}(\hat{K}) + 1$$

This will assure (3).

Let us denote by $J_0, \dots, J_{2k}$ the enumerated union $K_0, \dots, K_k, F_1, \dots, F_k$. Observes that for any choice of $(d+1)(2k+1)$ elements $z_0^1, z_0^2, z_0^3, \dots, z_0^{d+1}, \dots, z_{2k}^{d+1}$ in $\mathbb{R}^d$, such that $z_j^i \in J_j$ it holds that:

$$\sum_{i=0}^k \text{Size}(\hat{K}_i) + \sum_{i=1}^k \text{Size}(\hat{F}_i) \geq \sum_{j,i} L_i(z_j^i) \quad (1)$$

Later, we are going to take the points $\{z_j^i\}$ from the intersection of J_j 's. For convenience, let us assume that for the index subset $X \subset [2k] \cup \{0\}$, the intersection $\bigcap_{j \in X} J_j$ returns a single point. If there is more than one, then decide on the point in a way that all the chosen points simultaneously satisfy that for any index subsets Y, X , such that $X \cap Y$ and they both introduce a non-trivial intersection $\bigcap_{j \in Z} J_j : Z \in \{X, Y\}$, then:

$$\bigcap_{j \in X} J_j = \bigcap_{j \in Y} J_j$$

Now consider a non-trivial maximal intersection $\bigcap_{j \in X} J_j$, the intersection is maximal in the sense that for any $j' \notin X$ it holds that $\bigcap_{j \in X \cup \{j'\}} J_j = \emptyset$. We claim that for any i and for any such X , there is $t \in X$ such that J_t is the successor of J_j on the path to R_i for any $j \in X/\{t\}$. Assume not. Let $x, y \in X$, and denote the paths from J_x, J_y to the i th pole by $\langle J_x, J_{x_2}, \dots, R_i \rangle, \langle J_y, J_{y_2}, \dots, R_i \rangle$, such that $J_y \neq J_{x_2}$. If $y = x_2, y_2 = x$, or $x_2 = y_2 \in X$, then pick other x, y (if there is no such, we get an immediate contradiction). In that case, $\langle J_x, J_y, J_{y_2}, \dots, R_i \rangle$ is a path from J_x to R_i which is different from $\langle J_x, J_{x_2}, \dots, R_i \rangle$. Therefore, there are at least two paths from J_x to the i th pole, namely, there is a cycle in contradiction to the minimality of $K_0, \dots, K_k$.

We will choose the z_j^i by the following process. Pick a z_j^i that has not been set yet. If $J_j = R_i$, then set $z_j^i \leftarrow \text{pre}_i(x_i)$ - we call this a type-1 assignment. Otherwise, consider the path from J_j to R_i (by connectivity, it has to be such a one, and by minimality, there is exactly one). Let J_t be the successor on the path, then pick $z_j^i \in J_j \cap J_t$ - similarly, we call this assignment a type-2 assignment. Since any type-2 assignment is associated with a non-trivial intersection, and any non-trivial intersection induces a type-2 assignment for all i 's (since for all i 's, one of the J_j on its support is a successor of the rest on their path to the i th pole), we have that:

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{j,i} L_i(z_j^i) &= \sum_{j,i,z_j^i \in \text{type-1}} L_i(z_j^i) + \sum_{j,i,z_j^i \in \text{type-2}} L_i(z_j^i) \\ &= \sum_i^{d+1} L_i(\text{pre}_i(x_i)) + \sum_{X: \bigcap_{j \in X} J_j \neq \emptyset} (|X| - 1) \sum_i^{d+1} L_i \left(\bigcap_{j \in X} J_j \right) \\ &= \sum_i^{d+1} L_i(\text{pre}_i(x_i)) \end{aligned}$$

Plugging it into eq. (1) gives the desired. $\square$

7 Explantation of a Spanned Slice

[COMMENT] Here we follow the original proof, but change the triminology, m will be the number of leaves in the explanation, then in the end we conclude that the number of faults is at least m/Δ . So $|R| \leq f(\frac{m}{\Delta})$.

Definition 7.1. Consider a time graph (G, T) , an embedding $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^d$, such that.. Let $\beta = \frac{d+1}{\xi}$ and $\alpha = \beta \mathbf{Size}(\text{fork})$. Given sets W of points, R of arrows and F of forks, we define U as the set of vertices of the graph induced by the edges of $R \cup F$. The sets W, R and F form an explanation of a spanned slice $\hat{K} = \langle K, v_1, \dots, v_{d+1} \rangle$ if and only if:

1. $W \cup \{v_1, \dots, v_{d+1}\} \subset U \subset H_K$ and the graph $(U, R \cup F)$ is connected.
2. All elements of W are leaves.
3. For $m = |W|$ and $s = \mathbf{Size}(K)$ we have $|R| \leq \alpha(m - 1) - s$ and $|F| < m - 1$.

Claim 7.1. Every spanned slice $K = \langle K, v_1, \dots, v_{d+1} \rangle$ has an explanation.

Proof. Let $h = T(K) - \min_{u \in H_K} T(u)$. The proof is by induction on h .

1. Base: $h = 0$, namely T is constant on H_K , so no arrows connect points of H_K . Thus, H_K , as well as $\mathbf{K}$, consists only of leaves. In that case, $U = W = \{u\}$, $m = 1$, $s = 0$, and $|R|, |F| = 0$ satisfy the requirement.
2. Induction Step: $h \neq 0$ implies $K \neq H_K$. Thus, by claim 6.4, we know that for some k there exist spanned slices $\hat{K}_0, \dots, \hat{K}_k$ and forks $F_1, \dots, F_k$ that satisfy claim 6.4.

Consider $i \in 0, \dots, k$, denote by $s_i = \mathbf{Size}(\hat{K}_i)$. By the inductive hypothesis and since $T(K_i) = T(K) - 1$, we know that $\hat{K}_i$ has an explanation formed by a set of leaves $\mathbf{W}_i$, a set of arrows $\mathbf{R}_i$ and a set of forks $\mathbf{F}_i$. Let $m_i = |\mathbf{W}_i|$, So the sets R_i and F_i have at most $\alpha m_i - s_i$ and $m_i - 1$ leaves. We define:

- (a) $\mathbf{W} = \cup_{i=0}^k \mathbf{W}_i$, Notice that $\mathbf{W}_i \subset K_i$ and that $T(K_i) = T(K_j)$ for all i, j , thus by claim 6.1 $\mathbf{W}$ is a union of disjoint set, Hence W contains $m = \sum_{i=0}^k m_i$ leaves.
- (b) $\mathbf{F} = \{F_1, \dots, F_k\} \cup_{i=0}^k \mathbf{F}_i$ with at most $k + \sum_{i=0}^k m_i - 1 = m - 1$ elements.
- (c) $\mathbf{R} = \{\{v_i, \text{pre}_i(v_i)\}\} \cup_{i=0}^k \mathbf{R}_i$ with at most

$$\begin{aligned}
& d + 1 + \sum_{i=0}^k \alpha(m_i - 1) - \beta s_i \\
& \leq d + 1 + \alpha m - \alpha(k + 1) - \beta(s + \xi - k \cdot \mathbf{Size}(\text{fork})) \\
& = \alpha(m - 1) - \beta s + (\alpha + d + 1 - (k + 1)\alpha - \beta\xi + \beta k \cdot \mathbf{Size}(\text{fork}))
\end{aligned}$$

So its enough to show that for $k \geq 0$ the term in the closure is negative, We do that by showing that the slop is negative, and then the value of the term at zero is negative:

$$\begin{aligned}
-\alpha + \beta \mathbf{Size}(\text{fork}) & \leq 0 \Rightarrow \mathbf{Size}(\text{fork}) \leq \frac{\alpha}{\beta} \\
d + 1 - \beta\xi & \leq 0 \Rightarrow \frac{d + 1}{\beta} \leq \xi
\end{aligned}$$

And those inequalities hold for $\beta = \frac{d+1}{\xi}$ and $\alpha = \beta \mathbf{Size}(\text{fork})$. Finally, by claim 6.4, the graphs induced by $\mathbf{R}_i \cup \mathbf{F}_i$ are connected, thus the graph induced by $\mathbf{R} \cup \mathbf{F}$ is also connected. Therefore, $\mathbf{W}, \mathbf{R}, \mathbf{F}$ form an explanation of K .

□

8 Counting Subtrees.

Claim 8.1. Let $G = (V, E)$ be a $\Delta + 1$ -regular graph, and let k be an integer less than $|E|$. Fix a vertex $r \in V$. The number of subtrees rooted at r is at most α^k .

Proof. Denote by T_Δ and T_2 the infinity Δ and binary tress. There is an injection between the subtrees of G , rooted at v , with at most k edges, to the subtrees of T_Δ rooted at v , with at most k edges. Moreover, there is an injection from the subtrees of T_Δ rooted at v , with at most k edges to the subtrees of T_2 , rooted at v , with at most $k \log \Delta$ edges.

[COMMENT] In the second map, we think on replacing each of the vertex with $\Delta - 1$ -leaves binary tree, each leaf is associated with a outgoing edge. .

Thus, it's enough to bound the number of of subtrees in T_2 rooted at v , with at most $k \log \Delta$ edges, that number is less than the number of binary tress with $k \log \Delta + 1$ leaves. For exact leaves number we get the $k \log \Delta$ Catalan number, which its limit is:

$$\sim \frac{4^{k \log \Delta}}{(k \log \Delta)^{\frac{3}{2}} \sqrt{\pi}} \leq \frac{\Delta^{2k}}{(k \log \Delta)^{\frac{3}{2}} \sqrt{\pi}}$$

Therefore we can bound by:

$$\sum_{j=1}^k \frac{\Delta^{2j}}{(j \log \Delta)^{\frac{3}{2}} \sqrt{\pi}} \leq \frac{\Delta^{2k}}{\sqrt{\pi} \log^{\frac{3}{2}} \Delta} \sum_{j=1}^k \frac{1}{j^{\frac{3}{2}}} \leq \zeta\left(\frac{3}{2}\right) \cdot \frac{\Delta^{2k}}{\sqrt{\pi} \log^{\frac{3}{2}} \Delta}$$

□

Now, from here we get an upper bound on the number of subgraphs that connected l vertices at the top level. We bound it from above by counting combination of rooted subtrees, such the vertices are their root and the overall edges number is summed up to k . Thus:

$$\leq \zeta\left(\frac{3}{2}\right) \binom{k-1}{l-1} \frac{\Delta^{2k}}{\sqrt{\pi} \log^{\frac{3}{2}} \Delta}$$

9 Tree Separator Lemma

For a tree $T = (V, E)$ and a vertex $v \in V$, we call the subtree obtained by taking the descendants of v the subtree rooted at v .

Claim 9.1. Let $T = (V, E)$ be a tree with $m > 3$ nodes and τ edges, then it has a subtree with $m' \in (\frac{1}{3}m, \frac{2}{3}m)$ nodes and at most $\frac{m'}{m}\tau$ edges.

Proof. Order the vertices according to their heights. Denote by $v \in V$ the lowest vertex for which the subtree rooted at v has at least $\frac{1}{3}m$ nodes. Now, denote by T_1 the subtree obtained through the following iterative process over v 's children:

1. Initialize T_1 as the subtree rooted at v .
2. For a child u of v :
 - (a) Check if erasing from T_1 the subtree rooted at u doesn't decrease the number of nodes below $\frac{1}{3}m$. If so, then we update T_1 to be the result of the erasure.

Clearly, the algorithm is defined such that T_1 has to have at least $\frac{m}{3}$ nodes. Furthermore, since any child of v is a root of a subtree with fewer than $\frac{m}{3}$ nodes (otherwise we get a contradiction to the minimality of v 's height), we have that if T_1 would have more than $\frac{2}{3}m$ nodes, then the subtraction of any of its children would yield a tree with at least $\frac{2}{3}m - \frac{1}{3}m = \frac{1}{3}m$ nodes. Namely, v has in T_1 a child u such that the subtraction of the subtree rooted at u from T_1 results in a subtree with more than $\frac{1}{3}m$ nodes. But if indeed there were such a child, then the algorithm would erase it, so there is not.

Now let $T_2 = T/T_1 \cup v$, namely the tree induced by the subtraction of T_1 's edges from T . Observe that since the summation of nodes in T_1 and T_2 is the nodes in T , and T_1 has no more than $\frac{2}{3}m$ nodes, and no less than $\frac{1}{3}m$ nodes, it holds that the number of nodes in T_2 is also in the range $(\frac{1}{3}m, \frac{2}{3}m)$. We claim that at least one of the subtrees has fewer than $\frac{m'}{m}\tau$ edges.

To see this, denote by m_1, m_2 and by τ_1, τ_2 the nodes and the edges in T_1, T_2 respectively. Now:

$$\frac{\tau}{m} = \frac{\tau_1 + \tau_2}{m_1 + m_2} = \frac{m_1}{m_1 + m_2} \frac{\tau_1}{m_1} + \frac{m_2}{m_1 + m_2} \frac{\tau_2}{m_2}$$

Namely, $\frac{\tau}{m}$ is a weighted average of $\frac{\tau_1}{m_1}$ and $\frac{\tau_2}{m_2}$, and therefore it is greater than their minimum. Pick the subtree with the minimal quotient. $\square$

By repeating recursively on the above construction, we get the following corollary:

Corollary 9.1. Let $T = (V, E)$ be a tree with m nodes and τ edges. Then, for any $\alpha > 0$, it has a subtree with $m' \in (\frac{1}{3}\alpha m, \frac{2}{3}\alpha m)$ nodes and at most $\frac{m'}{m}\tau$ edges.

10 Tanner - History Connected Equivalency

Imagine the following process, we apply t noisy iterations of the SWEEP rule, and then a single ideal (without noise) iteration. Denote by ξ a deviated configuration (can be either bits or checks), and by ξ' the result of applying an ideal SWEEP rule on ξ . Notice that if ξ is connected in the Tanner graph then ξ' is connected in the History graph [\[COMMENT\] Require proof, For the classical case enumerate all the options can be done by hand.](#) Thus:

$$\begin{aligned}
\Pr[\xi \text{ connected in Tanner}] &\leq \Pr[\xi' \text{ connected in Time} \mid \text{no noise at the } t+1 \text{ iteration}] \\
&\leq \sum_{m=0}^{\infty} |\{\text{explanation to } \xi' \text{ over } m \text{ leaves restricted to no noise at the final iteration}\}| p^{\frac{m}{\Delta}} \\
&\leq \sum_{m=0}^{\infty} |\{\text{explanation to } \xi' \text{ over } m \text{ leaves}\}| p^{\frac{m}{\Delta}} \\
&\leq \Pr[\xi' \text{ connected in Time} - \text{Upper Bound}] \leq q^{\text{Span}(\xi')} \leq q^{\text{Span}(\xi)-1}
\end{aligned}$$

10.1 Another Idea.

Reconsider the construction of the explanation. We could add at the top an imaginary layer in which all the vertices at time t are connected by arrows to all the vertices (at time $t+1$) that are adjacent to them in the Tanner graph. For the last layer, we might find that the span of a slice expands instead of shrinking. Namely, claim [6.4](#) for the final slices would change to:

$$\sum_{i=0}^k \text{Size}(\hat{K}_i) + \sum_{i=1}^k \text{Size}(F_i) \geq \text{Size}(\hat{K}) - \xi$$

Thus, following the computation at the induction stage in claim [7.1](#), the number of arrows is bounded by:

$$\begin{aligned}
&\alpha(m-1) - \beta s + d + 1 + \alpha + \beta \xi \\
&\alpha(m-1) - \beta s + O(1)
\end{aligned}$$

11 Intermediate Step Lemma

[\[COMMENT\]](#) The idea of this step is also to bound the case that all the bits are flipped at once, So checks are satisfied (and the argue above is not applied directly).

Definition 11.1 (Connected Cluster With Span s). Let $G = (B, C, E)$ be a Tanner graph of a code, and let $f : G \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{d+1}$ be an embedding of the graph into $\mathbb{R}^{d+1}$. For $s \in \mathbb{R}$, we say that $X \subset B$ is a connected cluster of G with span s regarding f if X is connected in G (where two bits are connected if there is a check that connects both of them in E) and $f(X) \subset \mathbb{R}^{d+1}$ has $\text{Size}(f(X)) \leq s$. When it's clear from the context which G and f are, we will call X in brief a connected cluster with span s .

Definition 11.2. The model, computation, and noise are tossed, and then a correction is made.

Claim 11.1. Let ξ be the event in which, at the **beginning** of time t , the error contains a connected cluster with a span greater than $\frac{d}{4}$, and for $i \in [t]$, let σ_i be the event in which, at the **end** of time i , there is a connected cluster with a span of at least $\sqrt{d}$ that belongs to the error. Then:

$$\Pr[\xi] \leq t\Pr[\sigma_1] + p^{\frac{1}{8}\sqrt{d}}$$

Proof. By the law of total probability it holds:

$$\Pr[\xi] = \Pr\left[\xi \cap \bigcup_i^t \sigma_i\right] + \Pr\left[\xi \cap \bigcap_i^t \bar{\sigma}_i\right]$$

First, let us bound from above the probability of the right intersection, In that case, at the **end** of time $t-1$, the error consists of clusters each at span less than $\sqrt{d}$. Let m be the number the clusters and denote them by $X_1, \dots, X_m$. Now since the clusters are disjoint, the sum of their **Size**(X_i) is lower than the total number of the bits, namely:

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{i=1}^m \text{Size}(X_i) &\leq n \Rightarrow m \leq \frac{n}{\sqrt{d}} \\ p \frac{n}{\sqrt{d}} &\leq \sqrt{d} \end{aligned}$$

, Thus, . So denote by τ the number of bits that require to be flipped in order to merge the flipped connected component to a one with a span greater than $d/4$, So τ has to be at least:

$$\tau(\sqrt{d} + 1) \geq \frac{1}{4}d \Rightarrow \tau \geq \frac{1}{8}\sqrt{d}$$

Therefore:

$$\begin{aligned} \Pr[\xi \cap \bigcap_i^t \bar{\sigma}_i] &\leq \sum_{\xi^{(t-1)}} \Pr[\xi | \xi^{(t-1)}] \Pr[\xi^{(t-1)} \cap \bigcap_i^t \bar{\sigma}_i] \\ &\leq \sum_{\xi^{(t-1)}} p^{\frac{1}{8}\sqrt{d}} \Pr[\xi^{(t-1)} \cap \bigcap_i^t \bar{\sigma}_i] \leq p^{\frac{1}{8}\sqrt{d}} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \Pr[\xi] &= \Pr[\xi \cap \bigcup_i^t \sigma_i] + \Pr[\xi \cap \bigcap_i^t \bar{\sigma}_i] \\ &\leq t\Pr[\sigma_1] + p^{\frac{1}{8}\sqrt{d}} \end{aligned}$$

□

Definition 11.3. The atomic events are the sets of space-time locations in which faults occur. A run ω is the sequence of states (assignment of all the bits) induced by an atomic event (and the transition function of the machine). We say that a run ω closes a non-trivial cycle if it contains a state in which there is a connected cluster A such that its boundary is not a co-boundary.

Define the bits-cluster graphs $G = (V, E)$ such that the vertices are connected bit-clusters at different times $\{A_i^t\}$, and there is an edge between A_i^t and A_j^{t-1} only if $\Pi_x A_i^t \cap \Pi_x A_j^{t-1} \neq \emptyset$. Given a state at time $t - 1$ such that no connected component in G forms a closed non-trivial circle, consider $\tilde{A}_i^t$ constructed as follows: perform the application of either noise or Toom's correction in an arbitrary order and stop right before $\tilde{A}_i^t$ forms a closed non-trivial circle.

Claim 11.2. There is $\phi \in \text{Aut}(\mathbb{T}_n^d)$ for which $\text{Size}(\phi(\tilde{A}_i^t)) \geq n - 1$.

Claim 11.3. Consider a running in which no non-trivial circle was closed, then there is $\psi : \mathbb{T}_n^d \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}_{2n}^d$ such:

1. For any slice K , $\psi(K)$ is connected in $\mathbb{Z}_{2n}^d$.
2. For any t , denote by S_t the state at time t . Then, for any $t > 1$, we have that $\psi(S_t)$ is the image of the application of the Tooms rule over $\psi(S_{t-1})$.

Proof. We prove it by induction on time t .

1. Base case, $t = 1$. We will construct ψ in the following iterative manner. First, let ψ be the identity. Then, while there are slices that are not connected on $\mathbb{Z}_{2n}^d$, do the following: Let K be a slice that is not connected on $\mathbb{Z}_{2n}^d$. Then it can be decomposed into a disjoint union $K = K_1 \cup K_2$ such that K_1 and K_2 are connected on $\mathbb{Z}_{2n}^d$. Assume, without loss of generality, that for a coordinate $x \in [d]$, it holds that for any $a \in K_1$ and $b \in K_2$, we have $b_x - a_x > 1$.

Observe that there has to be at least one such coordinate; otherwise, it is a contradiction to K_1 and K_2 not being connected in $\mathbb{Z}_{2n}^d$. Then define:

$$\psi(z) \leftarrow \begin{cases} \psi(z) & z \cap K_1 = \emptyset \\ z + n\mathbf{1}_x & \text{else} \end{cases}$$

Repeat the above for other coordinates if $\psi(K)$ is still not connected in $\mathbb{Z}_{2n}^d$. The proof that $\psi(K)$ has to be connected (that the process ends) is omitted.

2. Induction step. We repeat the construction in the base case. To prove the second property, we show that ψ maps (un)satisfied edges to (un)satisfied edges. [\[COMMENT\] That is wrong.](#)

□

Claim 11.4. Denote by ω running of the above type, then there is a running ω' on $\mathbb{Z}_\infty^d$ such that ω and ω' agree.

Claim 11.5. Consider a t -steps running, conditined on the event that no trivial-cycle was closed in the $t - 1$ first steps, the probability that a non-trivial cycle will be closed at the t th step is less than:

$$\Pr \left[\Lambda^t \mid \bigcap_{t' < t} \bar{\Lambda}^{t'} \right] < n^{2d} \sum_{i=n-1}^{\infty} p^i \mathcal{J}_i \leq n^{2d} q^{n-1}$$

Proof. Consider the event in which there is a droplet that at time t closes a non-trivial cycle. Let $\tilde{A}$ be the subset of that droplet obtained by the process in claim 11.2. By the claim, $\tilde{A}$ has a boundary σ and two vertices on that boundary $M = \{u, v\}$ such that $\mathbf{Size}(M) > n - 1$, up to isomorphism.

Now, since no slice in the investigation of M closes a non-trivial cycle then by claim 11.3 .. so by claim 11.4 .. $\square$

12 Configuration up to $C_z^\perp$

13 Drafts:

In addition since, in a tree, the number of leaves is at least greater than the maximal degree, then we have that each J_j intersects with at most $d + 1$ elements.

$$\begin{aligned} L + \Delta_{\max} + 2(n - L - 1) &\leq \sum_{v \in V} \deg(v) = 2(n - 1) \\ \Rightarrow L &\geq \Delta_{\max} \end{aligned}$$